

HS 310: Japanese Language Class III

Course Code	HS 310
Course Name	Japanese Language Class III
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Those who have completed Level 2 or are recognized as having equivalent ability
Intended for	UG/PG/Ph.D
Approval	62nd BoA (Jan 2026)

Preamble

Building upon the knowledge of the “Japanese Language Course II”, this course comprehensively enhances the four skills of reading, listening, writing, and speaking.

After taking this course, students will be able to

- Expand vocabulary and kanji knowledge: Learn commonly used JLPT N4 level words and approximately 90 new kanji characters, enabling them to read texts for everyday use, negotiate with people in a wider range of situations, and make detailed statements about themselves and other things.
- Deepen understanding of grammar: Learn a wider range of sentence patterns and be able to express themselves in detail in a more extensive number of situations in everyday life and in the workplace.
- Enhance conversational fluency: Increase practical speaking and listening skills with an emphasis on role-playing and dialogue exercises that simulate life in Japan.
- Develop a deep insight into Japanese culture: Explore the cultural nuances of Japanese society, including etiquette, traditions, modern customs, and the current social issues in Japan, to gain a deeper understanding of the cultural roots of the language.

Course Modules

Classes are conducted according to the textbook ‘Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)’.

Marugoto focuses on communication using Japanese and consists of scene syllabus. It systematically introduces the sentence patterns, grammar, vocabulary and kanji step by step showing every situation where these things are actually used.

Each lesson provides opportunities to read sentences, understand grammar, practice pronunciation and speaking, solve listening comprehension questions and write sentences in Japanese.

About 90 kanji characters are introduced, and a worksheet is provided separately in class to give students the opportunity to practice writing them.

The course also includes a number of opportunities to understand Japanese culture and can be discussed with learners in class.

The textbook Minna no Nihongo and its supplementary materials are also used as part of the main textbook as appropriate.

Homework assignments are given as appropriate to supplement the study content.

[Time of lectures]

- The first lesson is Introduction. (1 hour)
- The second class will review the Lower-Intermediate Course. (1 hour)
- Intermediate Course covers Lessons 7 to 18 of ‘Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)’.
- Each lesson is scheduled for three hours. (36 hours in total)
- Exams (or assignments) are given in the middle and at the end of the semester. (4 hours in total)

(Total of 42 hours planned.)

[Title and Contents of lectures]

Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)

- **Lesson 1 – Is ten o'clock OK?:** Make an appointment / Explain why you are late
- **Lesson 2 – Have you been to see the night view yet?:** Talk about past experiences and future plans
- **Lesson 3 – Japanese is easy to pronounce:** Talk about the foreign languages you have studied
- **Lesson 4 – I'd like to go to Japan some day:** Talking about future goals and habits
- **Lesson 5 – What are you going to take to the picnic?:** Discussing and dividing up what to bring when going out
- **Lesson 6 – It looks delicious:** Comment briefly the taste of food
- **Lesson 7 – I have met Mr. Tanaka before:** Briefly describe your past experiences and current impressions
- **Lesson 8 – May I use this?:** Get permission for what you want to use
- **Lesson 9 – How about doing some exercise?:** Give recommendations and advice to others
- **Lesson 10 – I go running and swimming:** Talk briefly about what you usually do
- **Lesson 11 – I got this for my birthday:** Talk about things you gave or received
- **Lesson 12 – I think a party is a good idea:** Share your thoughts and what you've heard

Text Books

1. The Japan Foundation, *MARUGOTO: Japanese language and culture Elementary1 A2 Coursebook for communicative language competences*, SANSYUSYA, Japan, 2014
2. 3A corporation, *Minna no Nihongo Elementary*, 3A corporation, Japan, 2012
3. 3A corporation, *Minna no Nihongo Elementary II*, 3A corporation, Japan, 2013

References

1. Atusko Tokui, *Tabunka kyousei no Komyunike-shon: Nihongo kyouiku no genba kara*, ALC Publishing, Japan, 2020
2. Are Hajikano, *JLPT N4 Listening Comprehension Points & Practice*, 3A network, Japan, 2021
3. Arc academy, *Hajimete No Nihongo Nouryoku Shiken N4 Tango 1500 (English/ Vietnamese Edition)*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2016
4. Arc academy, *Hajimete No Nihongo Nouryoku Shiken N5 Tango 1000 (English/ Vietnamese Edition)*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2017
5. Keiko Hoshino, *Drill and Drill the Japanese Language Proficiency Test N4 Vocabulary Grammar/Reading and Listening*, Unicom, Japan, 2015
6. Kyoko Igarashi, *The Best Complete Workbook for the Japanese-Language Proficiency Test N4 – Language Knowledge (Vocabulary/Grammar), Reading & Listening*, The Japan Times Publishing, Japan, 2022
7. Kyoko Igarashi, *The Best Complete Workbook for the Japanese-Language Proficiency Test N5 – Language Knowledge (Vocabulary/Grammar), Reading & Listening*, The Japan Times Publishing, Japan, 2022
8. Musashino City Returnee and Foreigner Education Counseling Center Teaching Materials Development Group, *80 Easy-to-understand Pictures*, 3A network, Japan, 2001
9. Noriko Kobayashi, *Mastering Japanese by Ear*, Bonjinsha, Japan, 2024
10. The Japan Foundation, *IRODORI-Japanese for Life in Japan-Elementary 1*, The Japan Foundation, Japan, 2020
11. Tsuchiya Haruhito, *Customs of Japan*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2023
12. Yoji Yamakuse, Michael A. Coony, *Heart & Soul of the Japanese*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 2023
13. Yukiko Ogata, *Nihongo Fun & Easy II: basic grammar for conversation*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2018